From research to a live demo

A plain-language account of what Tantu is, what works, and what comes next.

THE IDEA

A better path from maker to market

Your SIH 26090 research showed that a basic photo-to-listing flow was not enough. You wanted artisans to explain prices, show craft stories, reach buyers, and keep working with poor connectivity.

01 Where it started

The research image was treated as **product context**, not a rigid technical specification. The project was shaped into an honest, working demonstration of artisan market linkage and smart cataloguing, with room to replace weak ideas with stronger ones.

02 What was built

Tantu is a three-role web app. It connects an artisan's product story and price to a searchable marketplace, a buyer's bulk requirement, and a direct conversation.

A Artisan

Create products, review suggested details and prices, publish craft passports, handle orders, and save drafts offline.

B Buyer

Browse crafts, describe a bulk need, compare makers, save a brief, enquire, and place a simple order.

A Admin

See platform activity and mark a passport record as reviewed. This is not independent certification.

THE CORE JOURNEY

Describe craft > review listing and price > publish passport > meet buyer

What the demo can do

Each capability is working in the demo, with the important boundary stated alongside it.

01 Smart cataloguing

Photo plus typed or spoken notes produce **editable** catalogue suggestions. Local craft rules keep the flow usable without an AI key.

Optional photo-and-text AI code exists; live provider use is unverified.

02 Fair pricing

The app totals materials, labour, packaging, logistics and overhead, then adds the artisan margin. The example is ₹3,000 cost + ₹600 margin = ₹3,600.

A market reference is separate; it does not change the formula.

03 Craft passport

A published product gets a public QR-linked record of its maker, place, material, technique and story.

Details begin artisan-declared. Admin review is not certification.

04 Buyer matching

A bulk brief is matched using craft, capacity, unit budget, material, location and lead time. Results show scores, reasons and gaps.

The ranking uses transparent business rules, not a trained model.

05 Demand insights

The artisan dashboard illustrates how recent sales could support production planning.

The current numbers are synthetic demo data, not a live forecast.

06 Offline work

Drafts and edits can wait in the browser and sync when connection returns. Version checks surface conflicts.

Unsynced drafts live on that device; clearing site data can remove them.

07 Voice and language

The interface supports English, Hindi and Marathi. Browser speech can fill stories and run key navigation actions.

Speech support varies by browser and may require a connection.

08 Simple commerce

Buyers can send enquiries and place stock-checked orders. Artisans can review orders and replies.

There is no payment, shipping, returns or tax integration.

From feedback to deployment

The latest change addressed your Hindi screenshot and was redeployed to the public demo.

03 The translation issue and fix

What you found: selecting Hindi changed the navigation, while much of Fair Pricing stayed in English. **What changed:** interface copy across pricing, home, marketplace, matching, studio, workspaces, notices, dialogs and accessibility labels now follows the selected language. Dynamic price explanations and match reasons were translated too.

Important distinction: artisan-written product names, descriptions and stories stay in the language in which they were entered. The language switch translates the app interface.

04 How it runs

BROWSER
React app + offline drafts

>

API
Node server

>

STORAGE
Records + photos

Local development uses SQLite and local files. The Vercel demo uses Neon Postgres and Vercel Blob. An optional OpenAI adapter suggests catalogue fields; it does not set prices or certify origin.

05 Delivery and verification

LIVE DEMO

tantu-artisan-market.vercel.app

At the last release check, **all 10 tests passed**, the production build succeeded, Vercel reported **Ready**, and the live Hindi pricing page was inspected. The workspace has a deployment command, but it is not currently a Git repository or an automatic push-to-deploy pipeline.

06 What remains

Tantu is a **public SIH demo**, not a commercial marketplace. It lacks independent authenticity checks and a demand model trained on real sales; photo improvement is basic. Real customer use needs stronger security and operations.

BEST NEXT STEP

Pilot with artisans and buyers on low-end phones. Next: AI photo enhancement, verified provenance, and demand guidance from real data.